

SMID SETUP BUILDER

Pre-Breakout VCP Watchlist | Qullamaggie Methodology

August 11, 2026 | 04:27 PM ET

MACRO REGIME: Risk-On (Large-Cap Leadership)

VIX 15.3 (-1.8 vs 20d) | SPY 20d +2.1% | IWM 20d +1.8% | IWM/SPY trend -0.3%

Leaders: Energy (+7.8%), Healthcare (+6.1%), Materials (+5.4%)

Setup Grades

A - Prime Setup (1)	B - Building (7)	C - Early Stage (4)
NIC	ACA	WSBC
	ORKA	CLDX
	IDYA	HWC
	SXT	ADPT
	MSGE	
	AUB	
	AEHR	

All Watchlist Setups

Gr	Ticker	Company	Theme	Mkt Cap	Price	Pivot	To Pivot	RS/SPY	Vol Dry	RS Hi
A	NIC	Nicolet Bankshare	Regional Bank NIM Re	\$3.72B	\$177.27	\$177.29	0.0%	+20.1	YES	YES
B	ACA	Arcosa, Inc.	Reshoring & Infrastr	\$7.12B	\$144.91	\$145.98	0.7%	+9.0	YES	no
B	ORKA	Oruka Therapeutic	Biotech Clinical Cat	\$6.31B	\$104.68	\$107.55	2.7%	+57.3	YES	YES
B	IDYA	IDEAYA Bioscience	Precision Oncology &	\$3.55B	\$36.84	\$37.90	2.9%	+26.4	YES	no
B	SXT	Sensient Technolo	Natural Ingredients	\$5.61B	\$131.90	\$132.46	0.4%	+9.5	YES	YES
B	MSGE	Madison Square Ga	Experiential Consume	\$3.75B	\$79.37	\$79.76	0.5%	+18.3	YES	no
B	AUB	Atlantic Union Ba	Regional Bank NIM Re	\$6.02B	\$42.15	\$43.19	2.5%	+11.3	YES	no
B	AEHR	Aehr Test Systems	AI Infrastructure &	\$3.82B	\$117.18	\$118.50	1.1%	+16.5	YES	YES
C	WSBC	WesBanco, Inc.	Regional Bank NIM Re	\$4.05B	\$42.19	\$42.50	0.7%	+22.8	YES	no
C	CLDX	Celldex Therapeut	Biotech Clinical Cat	\$3.48B	\$44.33	\$44.60	0.6%	+33.9	YES	YES
C	HWC	Hancock Whitney C	Regional Bank NIM Re	\$6.28B	\$78.22	\$79.36	1.5%	+15.0	YES	no
C	ADPT	Adaptive Biotechn	Precision Diagnostic	\$4.04B	\$25.39	\$26.16	3.0%	+81.6	YES	YES

NIC

Nicolet Bankshares Inc.

\$177.27

Pivot \$177.29 | 0.0% away

RS vs SPY: +20.1%

A PRIME

\$3.72B Cap | 20M Float

Regional Bank - Midwest Community | Theme: Regional Bank NIM Recovery | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 2.82

VCP BASE ANALYSIS	
BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	\$177.29
% to Pivot	0.0%
Days in Base	20
Tightness	2.82 Fair
52W Hi Prox	100.0%
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	155k <
Wk2	155k <
Wk3 (oldest)	235k
Coil Strength	34.1% from peak
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	+20.1%
RS Line New Hi	YES - Early Leader
Above 50MA	YES
Above 200MA	YES
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	\$3.72B
Float	20M sh
P/E (TTM)	19.9
Fwd P/E	13.2
Rev Growth	86.1%
Short %	5.5%
Inst. Own	-
Target Pr.	\$191.80

ENTRY TRIGGER
Close above \$177.50 on volume >150% of 20-day avg (>420K shares)
Target: \$195 - analyst target zone and ~10% measured move from tight base
Stop: \$171.00 - base low, also near 10-week MA

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE
EARNINGS
October 20 - Street estimates ~\$3.35 EPS on ~\$130M revenue. Forward P/E of 13.2x vs trailing 19.9x implies 43% EPS growth expectation. Revenue growth +86% YoY reflects acquisition benefit. Serial beater profile: management has under-promised and over-delivered on credit quality and NIM guidance.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Nicolet Bankshares is a Wisconsin-based community bank with \$8B+ in assets, serving commercial, agricultural, and retail customers across Wisconsin, Michigan, and Minnesota. The bank has grown through disciplined M&A and consistently ranks among top-performing community banks in efficiency and loan quality.
FACTOR & THEME
Exposed to regional bank recovery theme as NIM stabilizes post-Fed pivot. Healthcare sector leadership (+6.1%) is adjacent through bank loan exposure to healthcare systems. Regional bank ETFs (KRE) have shown relative strength; NIC's +20% RS vs SPY signals category leadership. Low beta (0.64) offers defensiveness in risk-off pivots.
NEWS FLOW
No material news in last 60 days; quiet consolidation after strong Q2 beat. No announced M&A, but management has signaled ongoing interest in tuck-in deals. Industry catalyst (Med): Fed commentary on rate path could move regional bank complex. No index inclusion events imminent.
INSTITUTIONAL
At exact pivot with RS line at new high - this is the cleanest technical setup in the batch. Vol dry-up confirmed (235K 155K 155K). Tight float (19.8M shares) means institutional accumulation is visible in the price action without volume spikes. No insider buying in last 60 days - neutral. Short interest at 5.5% with 2.5 days to cover is manageable, not squeeze candidate.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on a close back below \$171.00 (base low), or on credit quality deterioration / NIM compression guidance at Q3 print.

Textbook VCP at exact pivot with RS line at 52W high, confirmed vol contraction, and strong sector relative strength. Base_tight at 2.82 is slightly loose but acceptable given tiny float and clean price action. Strongest disconfirming argument: no catalyst within 2 weeks (earnings 70 days out) and regional banks are not in leadership - mega-cap regime may starve SMID breakouts of follow-through. Upgraded consideration given structural quality, but lack of imminent catalyst caps at A-minus conviction. Conviction: Medium-High.

NIC — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$177.29 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)



VCP BASE ANALYSIS	
BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	\$145.98
% to Pivot	0.7%
Days in Base	20
Tightness	1.35 Textbook
52W Hi Prox	98.6%
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	631k <
Wk2	645k <
Wk3 (oldest)	857k
Coil Strength	26.3% from peak
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	+9.0%
RS Line New Hi	no
Above 50MA	YES
Above 200MA	YES
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	\$7.12B
Float	48M sh
P/E (TTM)	32.3
Fwd P/E	28.3
Rev Growth	1.7%
Short %	2.4%
Inst. Own	-
Target Pr.	\$146.67

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above \$146.00 on volume >120% of 20-day avg (>830K shares)

Target: \$162 - measured move from 20-day base depth (~\$12) added to pivot

Stop: \$140.50 - base low and structural support

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

October 29 - Street expects ~\$1.28 EPS on ~\$750M revenue for Q3. Last 4 quarters show consistent beats (3 of 4 EPS beats, 1 inline). Earnings growth of +448% YoY reflects acquisition integration and pricing power. No recent guidance change; management reiterated full-year targets at Q2 call.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Arcosa manufactures infrastructure-related products across three segments: Construction Products (aggregates, specialty materials), Engineered Structures (utility poles, wind towers, telecom structures), and Transportation Products (barges, structural components). The company holds strong regional positions in aggregates and is a leading domestic manufacturer of steel utility structures and wind towers, benefiting directly from grid modernization and renewable buildout.

FACTOR & THEME

Core exposure to U.S. infrastructure bill tailwinds (IIJA), grid hardening capex, and onshoring of manufacturing. Materials sector is a current leader (+5.4% 20d), providing favorable sector wind. Peer read-through: MLM, VMC, and infrastructure-adjacent names have shown sustained institutional accumulation.

NEWS FLOW

Acquired Stavola aggregates business in 2025, now fully integrated - accretive to margins. Recent utility contract wins for transmission poles in Texas/Southeast. No imminent catalyst within 2 weeks, but steady backlog growth in Engineered Structures. Industry catalyst (High): Grid modernization RFPs accelerating into H2.

INSTITUTIONAL

Volume dry-up is textbook (856K 645K 631K) with price holding within 1% of pivot - classic quiet accumulation signature. Institutional ownership data unavailable from this feed. No insider buying in last 60 days, which is neutral given lack of catalyst urgency. Float is tight at 47.7M shares; a volume surge on breakout could move price quickly.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on a close below \$140.50 (base low and 50-day MA confluence), or if Q3 guidance is cut due to project delays or raw material cost inflation.

Textbook VCP structure (base_tight 1.35, confirmed vol stair-step contraction, within 1% of pivot) with favorable sector tailwind in Materials. However, RS line is NOT at new high, and no high-impact catalyst within 2 weeks - earnings 79 days out. Strongest disconfirming argument: with no near-term catalyst and mega-cap leadership regime, breakout may lack follow-through buying power. Conviction: Medium.

ACA — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$145.98 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)



VCP BASE ANALYSIS	
BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	\$107.55
% to Pivot	2.7%
Days in Base	9
Tightness	4.12 Fair
52W Hi Prox	97.3%
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	645k <
Wk2	883k <
Wk3 (oldest)	955k
Coil Strength	32.4% from peak
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	+57.3%
RS Line New Hi	YES - Early Leader
Above 50MA	YES
Above 200MA	YES
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	\$6.31B
Float	53M sh
P/E (TTM)	-
Fwd P/E	-37.8
Rev Growth	-
Short %	22.3%
Inst. Own	-
Target Pr.	\$149.58

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above \$107.60 on volume >130% of 20-day avg (>1.7M shares)

Target: \$135 - analyst consensus target zone; ~25% upside from pivot

Stop: \$95.00 - structural support and round number

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

November 11 - Pre-revenue biotech; P/E inapplicable. Cash burn and runway are the key metrics - last reported cash position should fund through 2027. No revenue estimates; focus is clinical milestones. Valuation reflects growth-stage premium; P/B of 10.9x is reasonable for biotech with validated targets.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Oruka Therapeutics is a clinical-stage biotech focused on biologic therapies for chronic skin diseases, leveraging half-life extension technology to enable less-frequent dosing. Lead programs target moderate-to-severe psoriasis and atopic dermatitis - large, growing markets with validated biology.

FACTOR & THEME

Direct exposure to biotech cycle recovery as risk appetite returns to clinical-stage names. Healthcare sector is leading (+6.1% 20d), providing macro tailwind. RS vs SPY of +57% is exceptional - this is momentum leadership within the sector. GLP-1 halo effect has lifted all immunology/chronic disease names. Peer read-through: RXRX, SRRK showing similar RS expansion.

NEWS FLOW

Stock has run from \$13 to \$105 YTD - likely driven by positive clinical readouts or partnership news in H1. 22.3% short interest is elevated and creates squeeze potential if positive data releases. No specific PDUFA date identified in near-term. Corporate catalyst (High): any clinical data update or partnership announcement could gap the stock significantly.

INSTITUTIONAL

Volume dry-up confirmed (955K 883K 645K) with price consolidating near highs - institutions are digesting gains and building positions. High short interest (22% with 5 days to cover) creates asymmetric upside if squeeze triggers. Institutional ownership data unavailable. No insider buying in last 60 days - typical for clinical-stage biotech where insiders are often locked.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on close below \$95.00 (10% from current, near psychological support), or on clinical trial failure / pipeline setback. Binary event risk is inherent - position sizing must reflect this.

Exceptional RS (+57% vs SPY) and RS line at new high signal institutional demand. Vol dry-up is clean, but base_tight at 4.12 is loose and base only 9 days old - needs more consolidation time. Strongest disconfirming argument: no identified near-term catalyst (earnings 92 days out), 22% short interest can work both ways, and binary clinical risk means this can gap down 50% on bad data. Healthcare leadership provides tailwind. Conviction: Medium.

ORKA — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$107.55 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)



IDYA

IDEAYA Biosciences, Inc.

\$36.84

Pivot \$37.90 | 2.9% away

RS vs SPY: +26.4%

B BUILDING

\$3.55B Cap | 94M Float

Biotechnology - Precision Oncology | Theme: Precision Oncology & Synthetic Lethality | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 1.49

VCP BASE ANALYSIS	
BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	\$37.90
% to Pivot	2.9%
Days in Base	20
Tightness	1.49 Textbook
52W Hi Prox	90.8%
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	657k <
Wk2	772k <
Wk3 (oldest)	773k
Coil Strength	15.0% from peak
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	+26.4%
RS Line New Hi	no
Above 50MA	YES
Above 200MA	YES
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	\$3.55B
Float	94M sh
P/E (TTM)	-
Fwd P/E	-9.0
Rev Growth	-
Short %	11.6%
Inst. Own	-
Target Pr.	\$52.15

ENTRY TRIGGER
Close above \$38.00 on volume >140% of 20-day avg (>1.5M shares)
Target: \$48 - near analyst consensus (\$52.15) with measured move upside
Stop: \$34.50 - base low and 50-day MA zone

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE
EARNINGS
Just reported Q2 on August 4. Pre-revenue; valuation via P/S (15.1x) reflects partnership revenue potential. Negative forward P/E (-9.0x) is meaningless for clinical-stage biotech. Focus is clinical milestones and cash runway. Recent quarter likely showed continued enrollment progress and GSK milestone potential.
BUSINESS & POSITION
IDEAYA Biosciences is a clinical-stage oncology company developing precision medicines targeting synthetic lethality - exploiting genetic vulnerabilities in tumors. Lead asset darovasertib targets uveal melanoma; pipeline includes programs across multiple tumor types in partnership with GSK.
FACTOR & THEME
Taps precision oncology theme - a durable secular trend with strong pharma M&A interest. Healthcare sector leadership (+6.1%) provides macro support. GSK partnership provides validation and reduces execution risk. Peer read-through: RXXR, KROS have shown strength on synthetic lethality / precision medicine data.
NEWS FLOW
Q2 earnings just released (Aug 4) - stock holding gains suggests no negative surprises. GSK partnership provides ongoing catalyst optionality through milestone triggers. 11.6% short interest with 6.7 days to cover is elevated. Corporate catalyst (Med): upcoming medical conference presentations or data updates could move the stock. No imminent PDUFA.
INSTITUTIONAL
Vol dry-up confirmed (773K 772K 657K) with tight base (1.49) - this is quiet accumulation. Post-earnings consolidation is constructive; institutions digesting Q2 data. RS line not at new high (90.8% of 52W) caps technical grade. No insider buying in 60 days - neutral for biotech. Short interest (11.6%) provides squeeze potential on positive data.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on close below \$34.50 (base low and recent support), or on clinical trial setback / GSK partnership restructuring.

Very tight base (1.49) with confirmed vol dry-up post-earnings - constructive setup. RS vs SPY (+26%) is strong, but RS line NOT at 52W high (90.8%) is a technical gap. Just reported earnings, so no near-term catalyst beyond data updates. Strongest disconfirming argument: healthcare sector leadership may not extend to clinical-stage biotech without specific data catalyst. Conviction: Medium.

IDYA — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$37.90 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)



SXT

Sensient Technologies Corporation

\$131.90

Pivot \$132.46 | 0.4% away

RS vs SPY: +9.5%

B BUILDING

\$5.61B Cap | 41M Float

Specialty Chemicals - Food & Cosmetic Ingredients | Theme: Natural Ingredients & Clean Label Trend | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 5

VCP BASE ANALYSIS	
BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	\$132.46
% to Pivot	0.4%
Days in Base	13
Tightness	5.56 Fair
52W Hi Prox	99.6%
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	257k <
Wk2	327k <
Wk3 (oldest)	837k
Coil Strength	69.3% from peak
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	+9.5%
RS Line New Hi	YES - Early Leader
Above 50MA	YES
Above 200MA	YES
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	\$5.61B
Float	41M sh
P/E (TTM)	35.6
Fwd P/E	26.6
Rev Growth	11.6%
Short %	5.2%
Inst. Own	-
Target Pr.	\$142.80

ENTRY TRIGGER
Close above \$132.50 on volume >150% of 20-day avg (>750K shares)
Target: \$148 - measured move from base depth + analyst target zone
Stop: \$125.00 - base low and structural support

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE
EARNINGS
October 30 - Street expects ~\$1.20 EPS on ~\$400M revenue. Earnings growth +36% YoY reflects pricing power and mix improvement. Forward P/E 26.6x vs trailing 35.6x implies continued acceleration. Management has maintained guidance; no recent cuts.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Sensient Technologies manufactures colors, flavors, and fragrances for food & beverage, cosmetics, and pharmaceutical industries globally. The company is a leader in natural color solutions, benefiting from consumer shift toward clean-label products and away from synthetic additives.
FACTOR & THEME
Exposed to clean-label consumer trend and premiumization in food & personal care. Materials sector is leading (+5.4% 20d) - favorable macro wind. Defensive characteristics (beta 0.78, stable margins) provide downside protection. Peer read-through: specialty chemical names with consumer exposure (IFF, GIVN) showing relative strength.
NEWS FLOW
No material corporate announcements in last 60 days. Stock quietly consolidating at highs - absence of news is neutral. Industry catalyst (Low): no imminent regulatory or industry events. 5.2% short interest is modest. No index inclusion catalysts identified.
INSTITUTIONAL
Massive volume contraction (837K 327K 257K, -69%) is textbook dry-up at the pivot - this is institutional accumulation. RS line at 52W high confirms relative strength. However, base_tight at 5.56 is loose - price action is choppy within the range. No insider buying in 60 days - neutral. Tight float (41M) supports price discovery on breakout.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on close below \$125.00 (base low and round number support), or on margin compression guidance due to input cost inflation.

Exceptional vol contraction (-69%) with RS line at 52W high and within 0.4% of pivot - structural quality is high. However, base_tight at 5.56 is the loosest in the batch, indicating choppy price action that institutional buyers don't fully control yet. Strongest disconfirming argument: no catalyst within 2 weeks (earnings 80 days out), and 0.4% to pivot with loose base risks false breakout. Conviction: Medium.

SXT — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$132.46 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)



Live Entertainment & Venue Operations | Theme: Experiential Consumer Spending | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 2.39

VCP BASE ANALYSIS	
BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	\$79.76
% to Pivot	0.5%
Days in Base	20
Tightness	2.39 Fair
52W Hi Prox	95.9%
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	331k <
Wk2	335k <
Wk3 (oldest)	367k
Coil Strength	9.9% from peak
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	+18.3%
RS Line New Hi	no
Above 50MA	YES
Above 200MA	YES
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	\$3.75B
Float	35M sh
P/E (TTM)	77.1
Fwd P/E	31.4
Rev Growth	1.6%
Short %	3.8%
Inst. Own	-
Target Pr.	\$80.71

ENTRY TRIGGER
Post-earnings: Close above \$82.00 on volume >200% avg validates breakout
Target: \$92 - measured move from base + recovery toward 52W high zone
Stop: \$72.00 - base low; wider stop needed for binary event

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE
EARNINGS
August 12 - EARNINGS TOMORROW - this is the primary catalyst. Street expects ~\$0.40 EPS on ~\$280M revenue. Last 4 quarters mixed (2 beats, 2 misses). Earnings decline -35.8% YoY is concerning. High leverage (debt/eq 2473%) creates earnings volatility. Earnings catalyst (High impact - binary event within 24 hours).
BUSINESS & POSITION
MSGE owns and operates iconic venues including Madison Square Garden and Radio City Music Hall, producing live entertainment events (concerts, sports, theatrical productions). The company is the pure-play on premium live experiences in the world's largest market.
FACTOR & THEME
Exposed to experiential spending recovery and premiumization of live entertainment. Communication Services sector is lagging (-1.9% 20d) - a headwind. Consumer discretionary crossover provides mixed signals. Peer read-through: LYV (Live Nation) has shown strength; venue operators lag ticket platforms.
NEWS FLOW
Sphere Las Vegas has drawn attention to Dolan-family venue assets. Q4 fiscal year end brings full-year guidance update. Corporate catalyst (High): tomorrow's print will either validate the breakout or invalidate it. Vol_ratio_today at 1.08 suggests pre-earnings positioning is occurring.
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume dry-up is modest (367K 335K 331K, only -10% contraction) - less convincing than other setups. Price at pivot with earnings tomorrow is a binary setup, not a technical one. Massive P/B (78x) and debt/equity (2473%) reflect Dolan family capital structure - not a fundamental red flag but governance concern. No insider buying in 60 days.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on earnings miss or weak guidance - expect -15% gap down risk. Close below \$72.00 (20-day base low) invalidates. Extreme leverage amplifies both upside and downside.

Earnings tomorrow creates high-impact catalyst - the core missing element for most setups. However, this is a binary event, not a technical breakout trade. Vol dry-up is weak (-10%), RS line NOT at new high, and sector is lagging. Strongest disconfirming argument: -35.8% earnings decline, extreme leverage, and Dolan governance history create fundamental concerns that technical setup cannot override. Trade only post-earnings with confirmation, not into the print. Conviction: Low-Medium.

MSGE — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$79.76 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)



Regional Bank - Mid-Atlantic | Theme: Regional Bank NIM Recovery | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 1.61

VCP BASE ANALYSIS	
BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	\$43.19
% to Pivot	2.5%
Days in Base	20
Tightness	1.61 Good
52W Hi Prox	96.6%
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	703k <
Wk2	912k <
Wk3 (oldest)	1356k
Coil Strength	48.2% from peak
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	+11.3%
RS Line New Hi	no
Above 50MA	YES
Above 200MA	YES
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	\$6.02B
Float	141M sh
P/E (TTM)	12.3
Fwd P/E	10.5
Rev Growth	35.8%
Short %	7.1%
Inst. Own	-
Target Pr.	\$47.00

ENTRY TRIGGER
Close above \$43.25 on volume >140% of 20-day avg (>1.6M shares)

Target: \$48 - analyst target zone and measured move
Stop: \$40.00 - base low and psychological support

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE
EARNINGS
October 22 - Street expects ~\$1.00 EPS on ~\$380M revenue. Massive earnings growth (+835% YoY) reflects acquisition integration - will normalize. Forward P/E of 10.5x is attractive for a growing regional bank. Management has maintained guidance post-Sandy Spring integration.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Atlantic Union Bankshares is a Virginia-based regional bank with \$24B+ in assets, serving commercial and retail customers across Virginia, Maryland, and North Carolina. The bank has grown through M&A (Sandy Spring acquisition) and maintains strong credit quality metrics.
FACTOR & THEME
Exposed to regional bank NIM recovery theme. Financial Services is not in sector leadership but not lagging. Earnings growth of +835% YoY reflects acquisition accretion and NIM expansion. Low beta (0.77) provides defensiveness. Peer read-through: regional bank complex (KRE) showing base-building behavior.
NEWS FLOW
Sandy Spring Bancorp acquisition integration ongoing - key execution catalyst. No material news in last 60 days. Short interest at 7.1% with 5.6 days to cover is elevated for a regional bank - potential squeeze if rates cooperate. Industry catalyst (Med): Fed rate path commentary moves the complex.
INSTITUTIONAL
Vol dry-up is strong (1.36M 912K 703K, -48%) with tight base (1.61) - institutional accumulation signature. RS line not at new high (96.6% of 52W) caps technical grade. No insider buying in 60 days - neutral. Acquisition integration creates execution catalyst but also integration risk.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on close below \$40.00 (base low and round number), or on credit quality deterioration / integration stumbles at Q3 print.
Strong vol dry-up (-48%) with tight base (1.61) - structural quality is solid. Acquisition integration provides ongoing catalyst but also execution risk. RS line not at new high and no catalyst within 2 weeks (earnings 72 days out). Strongest disconfirming argument: regional banks are not in leadership, and mega-cap regime may starve SMID breakouts. Conviction: Medium.

AUB — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$43.19 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)



Semiconductor Capital Equipment - Wafer Testing | Theme: AI Infrastructure & SiC Adoption | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 4.38

VCP BASE ANALYSIS	
BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	\$118.50
% to Pivot	1.1%
Days in Base	3
Tightness	4.38 Fair
52W Hi Prox	92.5%
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	2123k <
Wk2	2604k <
Wk3 (oldest)	4360k
Coil Strength	51.3% from peak
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	+16.5%
RS Line New Hi	YES - Early Leader
Above 50MA	YES
Above 200MA	YES
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	\$3.82B
Float	30M sh
P/E (TTM)	-
Fwd P/E	84.7
Rev Growth	33.7%
Short %	15.6%
Inst. Own	-
Target Pr.	\$115.00

ENTRY TRIGGER
Close above \$118.50 on volume >120% of 20-day avg (>3M shares)
Target: \$145 - measured move from recent base; analyst target at \$115 already exceeded
Stop: \$105.00 - recent consolidation low

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE
EARNINGS
October 8 - Street expects ~\$0.35 EPS on ~\$25M revenue. Revenue growth +34% YoY reflects SiC adoption tailwind. Forward P/E of 85x reflects growth-stage premium; valuation is stretched but justified if SiC adoption accelerates. Company has guided for ramp in H2.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Aehr Test Systems develops wafer-level test and burn-in equipment for semiconductor manufacturers, with particular strength in silicon carbide (SiC) power devices used in EVs and AI data centers. The company is a niche leader in a critical bottleneck for next-gen chip production.
FACTOR & THEME
Direct exposure to AI infrastructure buildout (power delivery for data centers) and EV adoption (SiC power devices). Technology sector is not leading but semiconductors have idiosyncratic strength. Peer read-through: NVDA supply chain names (AMAT, LRCX) showing accumulation. High beta (3.09) amplifies moves both directions.
NEWS FLOW
Stock has rallied from \$16 to \$117 over past year on SiC adoption theme. 15.6% short interest with 2 days to cover creates squeeze potential. No material corporate news in last 60 days - consolidating gains. Industry catalyst (High): any major EV or data center SiC design win by customers flows through to Aehr orders.
INSTITUTIONAL
Vol dry-up is massive (4.4M 2.6M 2.1M, -51%) with RS line at new high - textbook accumulation. However, base only 3 days old and base_tight at 4.38 is loose - needs more consolidation. High beta (3.09) and high short interest (15.6%) create explosive potential but also volatility risk. No insider buying in 60 days - neutral.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on close below \$105.00 (recent consolidation low), or on customer pushouts / SiC adoption slowdown. High beta means -20% drawdowns are routine.

RS line at new high with massive vol contraction (-51%) - structural accumulation is clear. However, base only 3 days old and base_tight 4.38 is loose; needs 1-2 more weeks of consolidation before A-grade consideration. Strongest disconfirming argument: forward P/E of 85x prices in perfection; any guidance wobble creates -30% downside risk given 3.09 beta and 15.6% short interest. Earnings 58 days out provides no near-term catalyst. Conviction: Medium.

AEHR — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$118.50 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)



Regional Bank - Appalachian/Mid-Atlantic | Theme: Regional Bank NIM Recovery | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 3.22

VCP BASE ANALYSIS	
BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	\$42.50
% to Pivot	0.7%
Days in Base	20
Tightness	3.22 Fair
52W Hi Prox	99.3%
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	742k <
Wk2	781k <
Wk3 (oldest)	1173k
Coil Strength	36.7% from peak
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	+22.8%
RS Line New Hi	no
Above 50MA	YES
Above 200MA	YES
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	\$4.05B
Float	91M sh
P/E (TTM)	12.0
Fwd P/E	10.9
Rev Growth	3.5%
Short %	7.3%
Inst. Own	-
Target Pr.	\$44.50

ENTRY TRIGGER
Close above \$42.60 on volume >140% of 20-day avg (>1.8M shares)

Target: \$47 - analyst target zone
Stop: \$39.50 - base low

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

October 21

Vol dry-up confirmed with price near pivot, but base_tight 3.22 is loose and RS line not at new high. Regional bank theme but no differentiation from AUB/NIC which are cleaner setups. No near-term catalyst (71 days to earnings). Monitor for tightening. Conviction: Low.

WSBC — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$42.50 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)



VCP BASE ANALYSIS	
BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	\$44.60
% to Pivot	0.6%
Days in Base	5
Tightness	5.69 Fair
52W Hi Prox	99.4%
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	776k <
Wk2	1171k <
Wk3 (oldest)	959k
Coil Strength	19.0% from peak
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	+33.9%
RS Line New Hi	YES - Early Leader
Above 50MA	YES
Above 200MA	YES
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	\$3.48B
Float	71M sh
P/E (TTM)	-
Fwd P/E	-10.6
Rev Growth	-97.0%
Short %	11.6%
Inst. Own	-
Target Pr.	\$58.07

ENTRY TRIGGER
Close above \$44.75 on volume >150% of 20-day avg (>1.5M shares)

Target: \$58 - analyst consensus target
Stop: \$40.00 - round number and recent support

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE
EARNINGS
REPORTED

RS line at new high with strong +34% RS vs SPY, but base_tight 5.69 is the loosest in the batch - price action is choppy, not controlled. Vol dry-up is partial (vol_dryup_strict false). Just reported earnings (Aug 6); needs consolidation time. Monitor for base tightening over next 2 weeks before upgrade. Conviction: Low.

CLDX — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$44.60 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)



Regional Bank - Gulf South | Theme: Regional Bank NIM Recovery | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 2.23

VCP BASE ANALYSIS	
BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	\$79.36
% to Pivot	1.5%
Days in Base	20
Tightness	2.23 Fair
52W Hi Prox	98.6%
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	680k <
Wk2	869k <
Wk3 (oldest)	1054k
Coil Strength	35.5% from peak
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	+15.0%
RS Line New Hi	no
Above 50MA	YES
Above 200MA	YES
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	\$6.28B
Float	79M sh
P/E (TTM)	15.3
Fwd P/E	10.7
Rev Growth	7.6%
Short %	10.0%
Inst. Own	-
Target Pr.	\$83.80

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE
EARNINGS

October 13

Decent vol dry-up (-35%) with acceptable base_tight (2.23), but RS line not at new high and short interest elevated at 10% with 6 days to cover. Regional bank exposure without differentiation; NIC is a cleaner setup in same theme. No near-term catalyst (63 days to earnings). Conviction: Low.

ENTRY TRIGGER
Close above \$79.50 on volume >130% of 20-day avg (>1.2M shares)

Target: \$88 - measured move from base
Stop: \$74.50 - base low

HWC — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$79.36 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)



VCP BASE ANALYSIS	
BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	\$26.16
% to Pivot	3.0%
Days in Base	9
Tightness	2.64 Fair
52W Hi Prox	97.1%
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	2540k <
Wk2	3461k <
Wk3 (oldest)	2737k
Coil Strength	7.2% from peak
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	+81.6%
RS Line New Hi	YES - Early Leader
Above 50MA	YES
Above 200MA	YES
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	\$4.04B
Float	124M sh
P/E (TTM)	-
Fwd P/E	-137.4
Rev Growth	21.5%
Short %	9.1%
Inst. Own	-
Target Pr.	\$25.07

ENTRY TRIGGER
Close above \$26.25 on volume >120% of 20-day avg (>3.5M shares)

Target: \$32 - round number and measured move
Stop: \$23.00 - recent consolidation low

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

REPORTED

Exceptional RS (+82% vs SPY) with RS line at new high - this is momentum leadership. However, vol dry-up is minimal (-7%) and vol_dryup_strict is false; accumulation pattern is unconvincing. Just reported earnings (July 29) and stock is digesting. High debt/equity (272%) creates balance sheet concern. Monitor for cleaner vol dry-up pattern before upgrade. Conviction: Low.

ADPT — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$26.16 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)

